

Merseyside BMX Club - Code of Conduct

Our Commitment

Merseyside BMX Club is committed to providing a **Safe, Inclusive and Enjoyable** environment for all riders, parents/carers, coaches, volunteers and officials.

The welfare and safeguarding of our riders is our highest priority. Everyone involved in the club has a responsibility to uphold the standards set out in this Code of Conduct and to act in accordance with **British Cycling's Code of Conduct, Safeguarding Policies, Regulations and Guidance**.

This Code of Conduct applies at **training sessions, races, events, travel, online spaces**, and whenever individuals are representing Merseyside BMX Club.

Code of Conduct – Riders

As a rider at Merseyside BMX Club, I agree to:

- Arrive on time and ready for training and competition.
- Wear appropriate clothing and safety equipment, including a helmet, as directed by coaches.
- Warm up and cool down properly at every session.
- Follow the rules and respect officials and their decisions.
- Show good sportsmanship and applaud good performances by all riders.
- Control my behaviour and language at all times.
- Never bully, intimidate, provoke or abuse others.
- Work hard for myself and my club.
- Respect everyone regardless of gender, ability, disability, background or religion.
- Ensure all fees are paid (by me or on my behalf).
- Not smoke, vape, drink alcohol or use drugs while at the club or representing it.
- Treat others as I expect to be treated.
- Cooperate with coaches, teammates and opponents.
- Remember that I represent Merseyside BMX Club at all times.
- Thank officials, volunteers and opponents after events when the opportunity arises.

Code of Conduct – Parents / Carers

As a parent or carer at Merseyside BMX Club, I agree to:

- Support the club in maintaining a safe, inclusive and enjoyable environment.
- Ensure that my child is supervised by an appropriate adult at all times when participating in sessions. For the purpose of this policy, a child is classed as any individual under the age of 18. A parent or carer must be present at all club sessions for those under the age of 18.
- Inform the club of any medical conditions or additional needs in advance, to ensure that sessions can be adapted as needed.
- Notify coaches if my child is leaving early or being collected by someone else.

- Encourage my child to learn the rules and race fairly at all times.
- Discourage arguing with officials and any confrontational behaviour.
- Focus on effort, enjoyment and development rather than just results.
- Set a positive example through my behaviour and be mindful of the language I use eg swearing in front of children.
- Never punish or criticise a child for mistakes or losing.
- Publicly accept officials' decisions and help children do the same.
- Remember BMX is for my child's enjoyment, not mine.
- Support the removal of verbal, physical and online abuse from sport.
- Respect the rights and dignity of all riders and families.
- Show appreciation for coaches, officials and volunteers.
- Follow instructions from coaches and officials without argument.
- Remember that both my child and I represent the club at all times.
- Not smoke, vape, consume alcohol or take drugs when attending sessions at the track.

Code of Conduct – Coaches & Volunteers

Coaches and volunteers at Merseyside BMX Club are expected to:

- Act in accordance with **British Cycling's Code of Conduct, Safeguarding Policies and Regulations**.
- Promote a safe, inclusive and enjoyable environment at all times.
- Act as positive role models.
- Put rider welfare and safety first.
- Support rider development at an appropriate pace.
- Never communicate directly via text message or online with a child under the age of 18.
- Never place themselves in a position where they are in a private, one to one situation with an unsupervised child.
- Have an awareness and understanding of any SEND needs that may need to be considered when planning and delivering sessions.
- Treat all riders fairly, respectfully and without discrimination.
- Create an inclusive, supportive and encouraging atmosphere.
- Use appropriate language and demonstrate positive behaviour at all times.
- Never humiliate, intimidate or abuse riders.
- Communicate clearly and respectfully with riders and parents/carers.
- Follow club safeguarding policies and British Cycling guidance.
- Raise concerns at the earliest possible opportunity with parents directly or through the Club Welfare Officer.

Behaviour Expectations

- This Code of Conduct applies to **all club activities**, including training, racing, travel and online communication.
- Any behaviour that undermines our values will not be tolerated.
- Bullying, discrimination, harassment, aggressive or passive-aggressive behaviour is unacceptable.

- Social media and messaging must be respectful and must not bring individuals or the club into disrepute.
- Welfare and safeguarding concerns should be reported to the Club Welfare Officer

Merseyside BMX Club Welfare Mailbox – Email : Needs adding

Disciplinary Action

Where behaviour does not align with the club's values and expectations outlined above, the following steps may be taken, depending on the nature and severity of the breach:

1. Verbal reminder of expectations
2. Formal written warning
3. Suspension from training and/or events
4. Termination of membership

Serious incidents, including threatening, abusive or violent behaviour, safeguarding breaches, or conduct which brings the club into disrepute, may result in **immediate suspension**, referral to **British Cycling**, and involvement of statutory agencies where appropriate.

Merseyside BMX Club

June 2026